

# AI Energy Consumption: Statistics from Key Sources [2026]

Posted by u/EchoOfOppenheimer • 0 points • 1 comments

A new comprehensive analysis of AI energy use reveals staggering numbers for 2026. While generating text is relatively efficient, generating just **1,000 AI images** produces carbon emissions equivalent to driving a gas car for **4.1 miles**. The report also warns that by 2028, AI-specific servers in the US alone could consume up to **326 TWh** of electricity annually, roughly 12% of the country's entire forecast power demand. The invisible cost of inference is now growing faster than training, meaning every day use is adding up to a massive environmental bill.

## Comments

u/Redebo • 1 points • 2026-01-15 19:52 UTC

It's a great thing that AI companies are already doing this optimization process, because they have to, because it costs real dollars to be inefficient.